



“I never sought special treatment or favours; instead, I focussed on absolute professionalism. If I expect to get equal respect, then I do equal work”

AMISHA VORA

Chairperson and Managing Director,
Prabhudas Lilladher Group

vice. These efforts helped us grow our business tenfold in a decade.”

Vora encourages women to take the lead in managing personal and family wealth. She says, “The goal is not just financial literacy, but financial confidence, which will enable women to make informed choices and become architects of their wealth.”

Priti Rathí Gupta, Founder of Lxme, has over two decades of experience in the financial services industry, during which she has inspired more than a million women to build their financial understanding and help them leverage their small savings.

The 53-year-old began really young: at 16, her father asked her to help manage their family’s portfolio. That experience laid the foundation for her passion. Later, she interned with her stockbroker uncle and did her Bachelor’s in Commerce, followed by post-graduation from SP Jain Institute of Management & Research in 2003-04.

Then, she set up a commodity

desk for her husband and ran it from 2004-2015. After this, she earned an MBA from Harvard Business School. She has also completed a postgraduate programme in family-managed business at SP Jain Institute of Management and Research.

“The commodity desk was part of the larger Anand Rathí Group, now known as Anand Rathí Commodities,” she says. In 2017, while still at Harvard, she was tasked with creating a strategy for a new business.

Thus was born the idea of Lxme, India’s first investment and financial platform for women. (It’s pronounced Laxmi, got it?) She launched it in 2020.

She says, “There was a gap in the market: There was no platform dedicated to helping women make informed investment decisions. Many doubted that women would engage with finance in a significant way. This scepticism was one of the biggest challenges I faced.”

While setting up the commodities business, she often faced clients who refused to acknowledge

her, preferring to speak to her male colleagues. “Those experiences, while challenging, made me stronger and more determined. From making my way to the male-dominated industry forums to now setting up Lxme, I’ve come a long way in the financial services industry—an industry that men have always dominated,” she says.

She believes that every challenge is an opportunity to learn and improve. “Strategic thinking and problem-solving skills to make a clear plan of action have also been instrumental in overcoming the challenges,” says Priti Rathí Gupta. Her group company, Anand Rathí, manages \$7 billion in assets, and Lxme, which she started in mid-2020, has an AUM of more than ₹30 crore.

She says women should strive for work-life effectiveness instead of balancing them. Her rule is simple: be 100% present in whichever role you’re playing at that moment. She says, “A day with a to-do list which I make sure I achieve through the day. For me, happiness takes prec-